

5 FLAWS IN WINDOWS 8

If you are under the impression that Windows 8 is the next generation platform for tablets and PCs think again. The fact that there are some imperfections in every OS stands true. Find out five flaws Windows 8 suffers from: <http://bit.ly/qRErV9>

RAY'S AT SHOE STORES?

The above headline may intrigue you but if folks at io9 are to be believed, then somewhere back in time X-rays were given at shoe stores. Next thing you know, barbers were dentists, but they were or were they? Read more here: <http://on.io9.com/pdN5wz>

**HOW DID THEY HACK SCARLETT JOHANSSON'S PHONE?**

Hollywood A listers' phones getting hacked has been talk of the town of late. Was there a racket involved in the whole operation? Do we really know how hackers can get hold of our phones and our precious data? <http://gizmo.do/o8VuiB>

EXPLORING THE STAR TREK UNIVERSE

Are you a Star Trek fan? If not, then you're missing out on a whole sci-fi legacy. However, folks at Ars Technica have been gracious enough to deconstruct the Star Trek universe for us. Delve into it and read more at: <http://bit.ly/o9LVbx>

SHORTS

A Concise Guide to Android Rooting

- By Jill Duffy

While putting together a list of the best Android apps, I asked dozens of Android devotees what their favorites were, and a few fired back a short list of apps "for root users"



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Rooting an Android phone is kind of like jailbreaking an iPhone. In layman's terms, it means you're cracking open the hood to access parts of the operating system that were intentionally locked to prevent you from messing them up, or doing anything to your phone that the manufacturer or carrier doesn't want you to do. A slightly more technical explanation is to say that rooting means giving yourself "root access," or greater privileges, or administrator control, to the lowest level of Android's Linux subsystem.

WARNING

If you didn't pick up on the clues above, rooting isn't for everyone and can have

serious repercussions. While it's perfectly legal, it can void your phone's warranty (more on that below). If you don't know what you're doing or aren't careful, you could potentially destroy your phone. Rooting also opens up more security risks because you can download apps that have access to files that would normally be hidden from them.

So, if you're perfectly happy with your Android phone as is, there is no reason to root it. If you're a tinkerer and understand the possible ramifications, then there are several reasons you might want to root.

WARNING:**Why Root Android?**

The purpose of rooting is to make the most of the device that you own by getting around the limitations that the manufacturer or carrier has put in place—and again, many of those barriers were put in place to prevent you from accidentally destroying your own device.

Here are some examples of what a root user can do:

1. Access the flash memory chip, which you need to do if you want to modify the Android OS or replace it with a customized version.
 2. Make the apps on your phone run faster.
 3. Remove pre-installed apps to free up space.
 4. Turn the phone into a 3G/4G WiFi hotspot without paying an extra fee.
- There are many other reasons to root,

too, but the ones listed here are certainly among the most popular.

TIPS FOR ROOTING

Before you dive headlong into rooting, here are a few tips:

1. **Be phone-specific.** This tip comes first for a reason. It's crucial that you look up information for your phone, and not just for Android across the board. Look for tutorials that are specific to the make and model of your phone, as well as any common problems. The rooting process varies by phone, and following the wrong procedures could cause irreparable damage. Just as important, not every rooted phone will be able to do what you might have been hoping it would. For example, not every rooted device has an unlocked bootloader (necessary to flash ROMs), so make sure you understand what you are getting into and exactly what you want the outcome to be if you root your phone.
2. **Read or watch the how-to beforehand.** Make sure to read or watch the entire tutorial before you begin, because there are often steps that are crucial that may appear out of order. For example, sometimes you need to disable anti-virus software on your computer at a certain step for the rooting process to go smoothly.
3. **Learn how to un-root.** Rooting is reversible on most phones—again, check whether yours is before you even begin.

